Landscape Architecture
PLACEmaking Team

Development Management Consultation Response

Officer: Andrew Norris Date: 03.02.2022

Reference:	Site:	Proposal:	Case Officer:
S/COND/21/1998	*Land North Of A420, Eastern Villages, Swindon*	*Discharge of condition 6 (Phasing Plan) from previous outline permission S/OUT/13/1555*	*Edward Snook*

Summary of Landscape response

- No Comment/No Objection	☐
- No Objection/ Subject to conditions	☐
- Not acceptable in its current format/subject to changes described below	☒
- Objection in principle	☐

Executive Summary

Thank you for consulting the Landscape Section of the PLACEmaking Team.

Overview: Whilst the 106 sets out trigger points for delivery of the formal open space typologies, the 'General Open Space' GI provision could foreseeably be left to the end of the build out period.

I would strongly urge that delivery of the green infrastructure / structural planting etc. is instead not left to the end of the build out period, but is provided as early as practicable, to ensure that this important green infrastructure is in place for the benefit of residents at the earliest opportunity, and a commitment to this clearly set out in the Phasing Plan.

Full Comments

My immediate takeaway from the Delivery Plan is that most of the triggers appear to be already firmly set out in the S106, so it appears that this directs the overall focus of the open space roll out on site, described in the phasing areas. Whilst this is a tested/logical approach, I'm concerned about comments raised by Highways regarding the potential reversal/swapping round the delivery of phases 1 and 4.

I concur with the comments made that this is likely to result in haul route(s) from Phase 4 (located at the western edge of the scheme) to reach those eastern phases that would be bought online ahead of what is currently described as Phase 1.

This could foreseeably have unacceptable consequences for timely open space delivery, compromising trigger points with potential knock on programme impacts which the schedules need to accurately reflect.

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Paragraph 3.10 appears to identify HHTW as the body responsible for delivering serviced land parcels with completed green, blue and grey infrastructure (e.g. open space typologies/drainage/primary access and movement networks), which I assume will then possibly be sold to housebuilders on a phased basis.

I am concerned that whilst the 106 sets out trigger points for formal open space typologies (LEAP/NEAP/Allotments/Sports Pitches/Community hub), the 'General Open Space' GI provision could foreseeably be left to the end of the build out period, at 95% occupancy. I would strongly urge however, that delivery of the green infrastructure / structural planting etc. is instead not left to the end of the build out period, but is provided as early as practicable, to ensure that this important green infrastructure is in place for the benefit of residents at the earliest opportunity, and a commitment to this set out in the Phasing Plan.

There is marked emphasis on the plan avoiding clear commitments to when infrastructure provision is likely to happen, and whilst I understand multiple influencing factors are in effect, a clearer (and possibly more realistic) commitment of anticipated timescales would be welcomed.

I look forward to receiving the supporting documents identified in 2.2 (Design Code/South Marston and Rowborough/FLEAMP/Open Space Parameter Plan and Public Art Scheme) and 2.3 (Open Space Strategy).